

MONSTERS

affected by **sleep** and **charm** spells. The DM is advised not to use shadows unless the party has at least one magical weapon.

Shrew, Giant

Armor Class:	4	No. Appearing:	1-4 (1-8)
Hit Dice:	1	Save As:	Fighter: 1
Move:	180' (60')	Morale:	10
Attacks:	2 bites	Treasure Type:	Nil
Damage:	1-6/1-6	Alignment:	Neutral

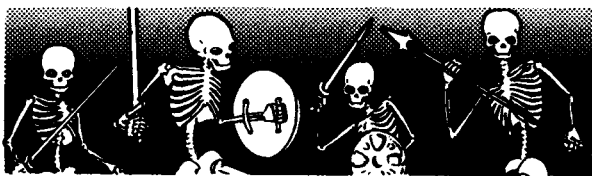
Giant shrews look like brown-furred rats with long snouts. They can burrow, climb, or jump (up to 5'). They are insectivorous and hunt insects, their main source of food. The eyes of giant shrews are so weak that the creatures are almost blind. They are not affected by light or the lack of it. Like bats, they use very high squeaks to "see" areas and things, and can listen to the echoes so closely that they may "see" things up to 60' away underground as well as a creature with normal sight. A **silence 15' radius** spell will "blind" a giant shrew. If it cannot hear, it will be confused, and then has an Armor Class of 8 and a penalty of -4 on "to hit" rolls. Giant shrews do not like large open areas, and remain underground most of the time.

Giant shrews often choose one area to hunt in, and will fight to defend "their" area from other animals (including humans). They are very ferocious and will attack anything. Giant shrews are very quick and will always have initiative on their first attack; in addition they will gain +1 on their initiative roll for their second attack. Their attack is so ferocious (attacking the head and shoulders of the defender) that when they attack any creature of 3 hit dice (3rd level) or less, the victim must save vs. Death or run away in fear.

Shrieker

Armor Class:	7	No. Appearing:	1-8 (0)
Hit Dice:	3	Save As:	Fighter: 1
Move:	9' (3')	Morale:	12
Attacks:	See below	Treasure Type:	Nil
Damage:	Nil	Alignment:	Neutral

Shriekers look like giant mushrooms. They live in underground caverns and are able to move around slowly. They react to light (within 60') and movement (within 30') by emitting a piercing shriek which lasts for 1-3 rounds. There will be a 50% chance per round of a wandering monster encounter for each round that a shrieker shrieks. The wandering monster will arrive in 2-12 (2d6) rounds.



Skeleton

Armor Class:	7	No. Appearing:	3-12 (3-30)
Hit Dice:	1	Save As:	Fighter: 1
Move:	60' (20')	Morale:	12
Attacks:	1	Treasure Type:	Nil
Damage:	1-6 or weapon	Alignment:	Chaotic

Animated skeletons are **undead** creatures often found near graveyards, dungeons, or other deserted places. They are used as guards by the high level magic-user or cleric who animated them. Since they are **undead**, they can be "Turned" by a cleric, and are not affected by **sleep** or **charm** spells, nor any form of mind reading. Skeletons will always fight until killed.

D&D: BASIC

Snake

	<u>Spitting Cobra</u>	<u>Pit Viper</u>	<u>Sea Snake</u>
Armor Class:	7	6	6
Hit Dice:	1*	2*	3*
Move:	90' (30')	90' (30')	90' (30')
Attacks:	1 bite or 1 spit	1 bite	1 bite
Damage:	1-3 + poison	1-4 + poison	1 + poison
No. Appearing:	1-6 (1-6)	1-8 (1-8)	1-8 (1-8)
Save As:	Fighter: 1	Fighter: 1	Fighter: 2
Morale:	7	7	7
Treasure Type:	Nil	Nil	Nil
Alignment:	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral

	<u>Giant Rattler</u>	<u>Rock Python</u>
Armor Class:	5	6
Hit Dice:	4*	5*
Move:	120' (40')	90' (30')
Attacks:	2 bites	1 bite/1 squeeze
Damage:	1-4 + poison	1-4/2-8
No. Appearing:	1-4 (1-4)	1-3 (1-3)
Save As:	Fighter: 2	Fighter: 3
Morale:	8	8
Treasure Type:	U	U
Alignment:	Neutral	Neutral

Snakes are found almost everywhere except for very hot or very cold places. Most snakes do not usually attack unless surprised or threatened. Many (but not all) snakes have poisonous bites.

Spitting Cobra: A spitting cobra is a 3' long grayish-white snake which can squirt a stream of venom up to a distance of 6 feet. It aims for its victim's eyes. If the spit hits, the victim must save vs. Poison or be blinded. (This blindness can normally only be removed by a **cure blindness** spell from the D&D EXPERT rules, but the DM may wish to invent other ways — such as eating a shrieker.) As with most small poisonous snakes, a spitting cobra will not attack human-sized or larger opponents unless startled or threatened. It can either spit or bite in one round, but not both. It will usually spit. The damage given (1-3 points) only applies to the bite; in this case, the victim must save vs. Poison or die in 1-10 (1d10) turns.

Pit Viper: A pit viper is a 5' long greenish-gray poisonous snake with small pits in its head. These pits act as heat sensors, with a range of 60'. The combination of pits and infravision makes it very hard to fight a pit viper; it is so quick that it always gains the initiative (no roll needed). Any victim bitten by a pit viper must save vs. Poison or die.

Sea Snake: Sea snakes are snakes adapted for living in the sea. All are poisonous. They average 6' long (for every 3 hit dice) in size, but can be much larger if the DM desires. They must come to the surface of the water to breathe once an hour. Their bite is little more than a pinprick, and will go unnoticed 50% of the time. The victim must save vs. Poison, and the poison is slow-acting; its full effects take 3-6 (1d4 + 2) turns to be felt if the saving throw is failed. (By the time this is felt, there is a 25% chance that not even a **neutralize poison** spell — see D&D EXPERT rules — can save the victim.) Unlike other snakes, sea snakes will attack humans for food.

Giant Rattlesnake: A giant rattlesnake is a 10' long snake with brown and white scales set in a diamond pattern. On its tail is a dried, scaly rattle, which it often rattles to warn off intruders or attackers who are too large to eat. Giant rattlesnakes are meat-eaters and their bite is poisonous (save vs. Poison or die in 1-6 turns.)